

World history timeline

This timeline lists some of the important events in world history and shows when they happened.

BC means before the birth of Christ.

AD means after the birth of Christ.

Jesus Christ is crucified about this time.

AD 1 30



Emperor Augustus

The Roman Empire grows across Europe.

100

Early people begin to make tools from stones.

30,000 BC



Roman soldier

Christianity becomes the official religion of the Roman Empire.

391

Flint arrow-head



Hieroglyphs Ancient Egypt is at the height of its power.

3,000

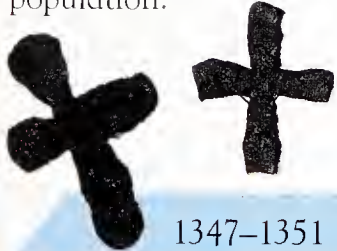


Mayan statue

Mayan civilization develops in Central America.

600

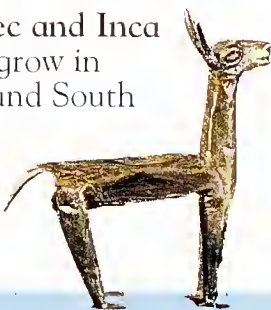
The plague kills one-third of Europe's population.



1347-1351

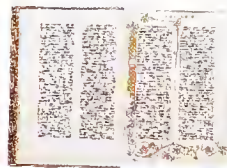
The Aztec and Inca empires grow in Central and South America.

Statue of a llama



1350-1519

The first printed book in Europe – the Bible – is made in Germany.

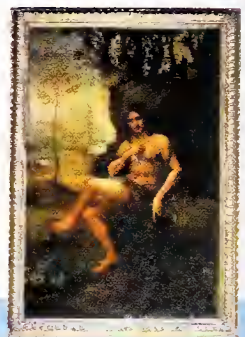


1455

The Renaissance brings great changes to life in Europe. It is a time of learning in science and art.

Painting by Leonardo da Vinci

1450-1600



The English Civil War ends and King Charles I is executed.

The execution of Charles I

1649



Peter the Great becomes ruler of Russia. He improves industry and education.

1682



The Revolutionary War ends British rule in the US.

1775-1783



George Washington becomes the first president of the US.

1789

Canada becomes independent from Britain.

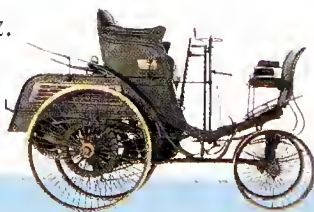


1867

The first automobile is invented by the German Karl Benz.

1898 Benz "Velo"

1885



The British Empire is at its peak.

1804-1885

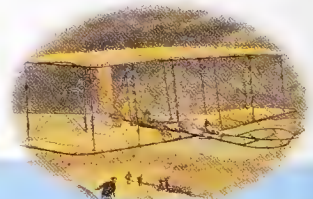
English hunting in India

Australia gains independence from Britain.

1901

The first successful airplane flight is made by American Orville Wright.

1903



Australia welcomes about 2 million settlers from Europe.



1952

1945

Gandhi leads the movement for Indian independence from Britain.

1947



Mao Tse-tung makes China a communist republic.



1949

Germany is split into West Germany and communist East Germany.



Mount Everest, the world's highest mountain, is climbed by Edmund Hillary and Sherpa Tenzing Norgay.

1953